

Status Effects

Status Effects Overview

Status Effects represent ongoing conditions—beneficial or harmful—that alter a character’s capabilities, resource flow, or behavior in and out of combat. Most effects are applied in **stacks**, each of which may amplify its intensity or duration. Some effects tick at the **start of a turn** (Upkeep), some are triggered by **actions** (like attacking or defending), and others persist until removed by specific actions, abilities, or cleansing effects.

Unless otherwise stated, effects **stack cumulatively** and **one stack is removed** during each appropriate trigger (e.g., per round, per use). Understanding stack behavior is critical to survival and mastery within the Unbound System.

State Change Status Effects

Name	Effect
Bind	Can not take actions that require arms and hands. Upkeep: Remove 1 stack.
Charmed	Target becomes friendly to charmer and allies. Lose stacks equal to any damage received. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Fear	Use all AP to move away from the enemy that applied the fear stack up to a specified range. SP costs still apply. End turn: Remove 1 stack.
Freeze	Target can not take Actions and immune to damage instead reducing Stacks by Damage taken. One stack still prevents all damage taken for the action that removes the last stack. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Grappled	Attacker binds or roots target but can't take further action with appendages used except to make unarmed constraining attacks against the target and may release as free reaction. Constrain: 2AP: Squeeze target for STR physical damage. Upkeep: May maintain Grapple. Target Upkeep: Make opposing STR or SPT checks. If Target succeeds, break grapple and take turn as normal.
Pacify	Can not attack. Remove 1 stack when damaged. Upkeep: Lose 1 stack.
Paralyzed	Can't use SP. Lose stacks equal to damage taken. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Root	Can not take actions that require legs and feet. Upkeep: Remove 1 stack.
Silenced	Can't activate verbal components or make sound based attacks. Lose stacks equal to damage taken. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Sleep	Become unconscious and prone until saved. Turn start roll SPT or MND vs attackers success roll. On success: remove sleep but remain prone. The attacker doesn't reroll, use the same value.
Stunned	Cannot take actions. Lose stacks equal to damage taken. Upkeep: Lose a stack.

Actions Status Effects

Name	Effect
Crippled	Move SPD/2. Turn end with haven taken a move action: lose a stack.
Haste	Go up one initiative position when the first stack is applied. If this would cause the turn of the active Character to move above a Character who has already acted this round, that Character does not take another Turn. At turn start: Gain an AP then lose a stack.
Hindered	Reduce SPD by 5 per stack. Lose a stack on Move. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Momentum	Move SPD×2. On non-move action and on turn end without having taken a move action: lose a stack.
Anticipate	Defenses cost one less HP, SP, or MP. On defend and upkeep: Lose a stack.
Quicken	Increase SPD by 5 per stack. Lose a stack on move. Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Slow	Go down one initiative position when first stack is applied. If this would drop a Character below another Character's initiative, pause the Character's turn until the other Character's turn is complete. At turn start: Lose an AP then lose a stack.
Off-balance	Defenses cost an extra HP, SP, or MP. On defend and upkeep: Lose a stack.

Stat Pool Status Effects

If Max pool is reduced below current pool lose the excess.

Name	Effect
Baffle	Reduce Max MP by 2 per stack. If MP hits 0, character is unconscious. On MP use: Lose a stack.
Bleed	Lose HP equal to AP spent, after action costs, then lose a stack.
Bolster	Increase current and Max HP by 4 per stack. Excess lost if current HP < Max.
Clarity	Increase current and Max MP by 4 per stack. Upkeep: Lose a stack
Concentration	Gain MP equal to AP spent, then lose a stack.
Confuse	Lose MP equal to AP spent, after action costs, then lose a stack.
Demoralize	Reduce current and Max SP by 2 per stack. If SP hits 0, character is unconscious and prone. Remove 1 stack on the character's first AP spent per turn.
Depression	Reduce MPR equal to stacks. After MPR triggers lose a stack.
Determination	Gain HP equal to AP spent, then lose a stack.
Enfeeble	Reduce current and Max HP by 2 per stack. Excess lost if current HP < Max.
Exhaust	Lose SP equal to AP spent, after action costs, then lose a stack.
Fatigue	Reduce SPR equal to stacks. After SPR triggers lose a stack.

Flow	SP abilities cost 1 less per stack. On SP use: lose a stack.
Focus	MP abilities cost 1 less per stack. On MP use: lose a stack.
Inspiration	Gain SP equal to AP spent, then lose a stack.
Invigorate	Increase current and Max SP by 4 per stack. Lose current SP if Max reduced.
Regenerate	Gain HPR equal to stacks. After HPR trigger lose a stack.
Rejuvenate	Gain SPR equal to stacks. After SPR triggers lose a stack.
Replenish	Gain MPR equal to stacks. After MPR triggers lose a stack.
Sicken	SP abilities cost 1 more per stack. On SP use: lose a stack.
Stupify	MP abilities cost 1 more per stack. On MP use: lose a stack.
Injure	Reduce HPR equal to stacks. After HPT triggers lose a stack.

Attack and Defense Status Effects

Name	Effect
Alert	Gain +4 to Block and Dodge, then lose a stack.
Blessed	Double healing received, then lose a stack.
Blind	-4 to hit with melee, -8 to hit with range attacks. Blind sight mitigates. Upkeep: Remove a stack.
Defile	Reduce healing received by stacks, then lose a stack.
Disorient	Lose 4 to attacks. After attacking, lose a stack.
Distract	Lose 4 to Block and Dodge, then lose a stack.
Exploit	Gain +4 to attacks and abilities, then lose a stack.
Foresight	Gain +4 to Dodge and Deflect, then lose a stack.
Prone	1 AP to stand. Reduce ranged attack rolls to hit by 2 and increase melee attacks to hit by 4.
Sanctify	Increase healing received by stacks, then lose a stack.
Sluggish	Lose 4 to Dodge and Deflect, then lose a stack.
Staggered	Can't perform more than one attack per turn or somatic spell components.
Wound	Halve healing received from abilities, rounded up, then lose a stack.

Damage and Modifiers Status Effects

Name	Effect
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Barrier	When Hit: Increase physical DR by stacks, then lose stacks equal to Damage Resisted. Prevents on-hit effects if damage is reduced to 0 by Barrier stacks.
Black Mark	On hit: take extra Void damage equal to stacks, then lose a stack. End turn: Lose a stack then take damage equal to the remaining stacks.
Brittle	When hit, take double damage, then lose a stack.
Burn	Heat damage on hit: take extra Heat damage equal to stacks, then lose a stack. End turn: Lose a stack then take damage equal to the remaining stacks.
Chill	Cold damage on hit: take extra Cold damage equal to stacks, then lose a stack. End turn: Lose a stack then take damage equal to the remaining stacks.
Crushed	Bludgeoning damage on hit: take extra damage of type equal to stacks, then lose a stack.
Cursed	Upkeep: Deal Shadow damage equal to stacks, then lose a stack.
Empower	Double damage <i>bonuses</i> on hit, then lose a stack.
Enrage	+2 attack and -2 defense rolls per stack. When character Hits and during Upkeep: Lose a stack.
Grace	Light on hit: Target takes additional damage (undead) or healing equal to stacks, then loses a stack. Upkeep: Lose a stack then take Light healing or damage equal to stacks.
Grit	When hit, take half damage, then lose a stack.
Harden	Prevent up to stacks of physical damage; energy on-hits still trigger. Lose a stack.
Poison	Upkeep: Deal physical damage equal to stacks, then lose a stack.
Protect	Prevent up to stacks of magic damage of a type; non-energy on-hits trigger. Lose a stack.
Resistant	Reduce affinity damage taken by half. Affinity attack hit: Remove a stack. Upkeep: Remove a stack.
Weaken	Deal half damage on hit, then lose a stack.
Weather	Slash on hit: take extra damage of type equal to stacks, then lose a stack. End turn: Lose a stack then take damage equal to the remaining stacks.
Void Touch	Void damage or healing (undead) on hit: take extra Void damage or healing equal to stacks, then lose a stack. End turn: Lose a stack then take damage or healing equal to the remaining stacks.
Vulnerable	Double affinity damage taken. Affinity attack hit: Remove a stack. End Turn: Remove a stack.

Social Status Effects

Name	Effect
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Embarrassed	-2 to all social rolls. Upkeep: remove a stack.
Furious	+2 intimidation and -2 persuasion per stack. Upkeep: remove a stack.
Exposed	Cannot use Deception. Social defenses +2 vs this character. Upkeep: remove a stack.
Enthralled	-2 social defense vs persuasion and seduction. Upkeep: remove a stack.